

Profile Chart Window (TPO and Volume Profiles)

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The Profile Chart is a dedicated window for profile-style analysis: TPO (Market Profile) letter profiles, daily and weekly volume profiles, delta profiles and a composite profile — stackable as overlays on one time axis. It shares the price chart's toolbar, drawing tools, right-click menu and trading panel, but its whole rendering engine is built around profiles instead of candles.

This article covers the window: opening it, the header controls, the profile-type toggle row, the Indicators panel that actually drives it, and what to do when the chart goes blank. For the theory of profiles, start with Understanding Volume Profile: POC, Value Area, HVN/LVN; for the TPO indicator you can add to a normal price chart, see Market Profile (TPO).

What it is

Instead of asking "where did price go over time" (a candle chart), a profile chart asks "how much time and volume did the market spend at each price". Each session renders as a distribution: TPO letters mark which time periods touched each price, and volume-profile bars show how many contracts traded there. The window can layer several profile types side by side per session — for example TPO letters plus a daily volume profile — and adds weekly and composite profiles in their own areas at the right edge.

To get a feel for the volume side, try the interactive profile below — drag the Value Area % and watch the VAH/VAL lines and the magenta POC respond, or hover the rows for per-level volume.

[WIDGET: volume-profile-lab]

When to use it

- Reading session structure: value areas, points of control, single prints and unfinished business (Understanding Auction Theory: Imbalance, Unfinished Auctions, Absorption).
- Comparing today's developing value against prior sessions at a glance.
- Separating RTH and ETH activity — the toggle row has dedicated RTH/ETH variants of both TPO and volume profiles.
- Zooming out to weekly and composite profiles for higher-timeframe levels.
- Trading directly off profile levels — the window docks the same trading panel as a price chart.

Quick start

1. In the main bar, open **New** → **Profile Chart**.
2. Pick your instrument in **Select Instrument** and confirm. Only exchanges subscribed in Symbol Manage: Subscribe Exchanges and Map Your Feed appear.
3. Wait while the window shows **Building chart** (or **Downloading data from connection**). The main bar shows an **LDT**: badge when data is loading from disk, or **DWT**: when it is downloading from the feed server — both are normal loading states.
4. The chart renders with TPO profiles per session. Enable more profile types from the bottom toggle row as needed.

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER] Profile Chart window freshly opened on NQ showing the Building chart spinner with progress bar, and the main bar LDT badge visible at the top `profile-chart-building.png`

Window anatomy

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER] Fully rendered Profile Chart on NQ in TPO mode showing the header with symbol dropdown, 30D - BT dropdown and ticks-grouping dropdown, the top toolbar icons, the left drawing rail, per-session TPO

letter profiles with magenta POC lines and dashed value-area lines, and the bottom profile-type toggle row
profile-chart-overview.png

- **Header controls** — the symbol dropdown (for example NQ-202609), a history dropdown reading like **30D - BT** (30 days of history loaded; BT stands for Based on Tick, the same label family as on price charts — the full option list of this dropdown on the Profile Chart is **[CONFIRM: options offered by the Profile Chart history dropdown]**), the ticks-grouping dropdown (**N T** — see below), an open-in-new icon and a green plus icon, then the standard link/minimize/maximize/close controls.
- **Top toolbar** — the same family as the price chart: hamburger, link-charts, the indicators icon, gear, \$ (trading) and camera.
- **Left drawing rail** — pointer, hand, add, crosshair, zoom, eye, eraser, horizontal/vertical line, ray, rectangle, ellipse, text and position-calculator tools; see Drawing Tools and Annotations.
- **Top-left readout** — O H L C plus %V (percent change versus the previous day), ΣV and ΔV for the hovered session. ΣV and ΔV read as total volume and delta of the session, but their exact definitions are **[CONFIRM: precise ΣV and ΔV definitions in the readout]**.
- **Bottom toggle row** — the profile types (next section) with a **Trading panel** toggle at the right end.

Ticks grouping (the N T dropdown)

The **N T** dropdown sets the ticks grouping, with presets such as **1 T**, **20 T** and **100 T** plus a **Set Ticks Grouping** dialog (numeric field with **Cancel**, **Apply** and **Set** buttons) for custom values. Larger values group more ticks per profile row, which appears to control the row height — exact semantics unconfirmed. Changing the value rebuilds the chart: a **Building chart** spinner in between is normal.

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER] The ticks-grouping dropdown open showing the 1 T, 20 T and 100 T presets, with the Set Ticks Grouping dialog open showing the numeric field and Cancel, Apply and Set buttons
profile-chart-ticks-grouping.png

Profile types: the bottom toggle row

The row along the bottom lists every profile type: **TPO | Dly Vol. Profile | Dly Vol. Profile (ETH) | TPO (ETH) | TPO (RTH) | Dly Vol. Profile (RTH) | Dly Delta Profile | Wkly Vol. Profile | Wkly Delta Profile | Comp. Vol. Profile**. When the window is narrow the labels abbreviate to **TPO | D-VP | D-VP (ETH) | TPO (ETH) | TPO (RTH) | D-VP (RTH) | D-DP | W-VP | W-DP | C-VP** — the same abbreviation family as the chart's quick templates (Quick Chart Templates (OF-VP, D-VP, W-VP...)): D-VP = daily volume profile, D-DP = daily delta profile, W-VP/W-DP = weekly volume/delta profile, C-VP = composite profile of all loaded data.

Tip: The row looks like radio buttons but is multi-select. Each enabled type adds an overlay — TPO letters plus a daily volume profile plus an RTH variant can all draw at once, side by side per session.

Two placement rules:

- **Daily types** (TPO and Dly profiles, including ETH/RTH variants) draw per-session inside the main chart area.
- **Weekly and Composite types** each get their own full-height vertical area at the right edge of the chart, axis-labeled **W-VP**, **W-DP** or **C-VP**, with one histogram each.

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER] Profile Chart with several toggles enabled at once — TPO letters plus daily volume-profile bars per session in the main area, and three vertical areas labeled W-VP, W-DP and C-VP at the right edge each holding a full-height histogram
profile-chart-multi-overlays.png

The Indicators panel

The toolbar's indicators icon opens the **Indicators** panel — the real state behind the toggle row. Every profile type is an indicator instance with a systematic name: **DT:** = TPO letters, **DP: Vol** = volume profile, **DP: Delta** = delta profile; **Multiple 1 D** = one per day, **Multiple 1 W** = weekly, **Composite** = the whole loaded range. Instances live in **Chart Area 1** (the main area) or **Vertical Chart Area 1/2/3** (the right-edge columns). Each

row has a trash icon (delete), an eye icon (show/hide, applies live) and a gear icon (settings), plus a green **Indicators** button.

The toggle row and this panel can briefly fall out of step after rapid toggling — when in doubt, trust the Indicators panel; it reflects what is actually drawn. Whether you can add further profile instances beyond the toggle presets via the green button is **[CONFIRM: adding extra DT/DP instances through the Indicators button]**.

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER] Indicators panel open over the Profile Chart listing Chart Area 1 with Price and several DT and DP: Vol instances, plus Vertical Chart Areas 1-3 each holding one weekly or composite instance, with the trash, eye and gear icons visible per row `profile-chart-indicators-panel.png`

How to read it

In TPO mode each session draws as a letter profile: every letter marks a time period of the session, so a price row with many letters held trading interest through many periods, while single letters at the extremes mark brief excursions. A magenta line marks each session's POC (the most-traded/most-visited level) and dashed lines mark the value-area boundaries, following standard Market Profile conventions — see Market Profile (TPO) for the full interpretation toolkit.

Several visual details of this window are not yet documented and their exact meaning may vary: the letter color groups, the underlined rows, and the green, purple and yellow vertical bars flanking each session. The same applies to the heat-style colors (yellow/orange/red/green/magenta) on volume-profile bars. Describe levels by their structure (POC, value area, singles) rather than relying on these colors until they are confirmed. **[CONFIRM: legend for TPO letter colors, underlined rows, per-session vertical range bars, and volume-profile heat colors]**

Press play on the interactive profile below to watch a session's letters stack period by period — hover any row to see which periods touched that price, and watch the POC and value area form.

[WIDGET: tpo-lab]

Trading from the Profile Chart

The **Trading panel** toggle (right end of the bottom row) docks the same right-side trading panel as the price chart: symbol, open quantity and P/L readouts, **Qty**, **Broker/Account**, the **MKT | BID-ASK | LMT | STP | STP LMT** button grid, **Cancel + Breakeven**, **Cancel and Flat**, the OCO strategy block with **Server/Client** radios and **Link pending orders**. The **\$** toolbar icon turns green when trading is enabled.

The right-click menu is the same family as the price chart — pointer/crosshair/hand/zoom modes, **Drawing Objects** and **Drawing Utilities**, **Trading Enabled** (Ctrl Alt T), **Show Trading Panel** (Ctrl Alt P), **Show Historical Orders**, **Trading Settings**, **Rebuild Chart**, **Template**, **Indicators** (Ctrl I) and **Properties** (Ctrl P) — plus one extra entry at the bottom for the indicator under the cursor (for example "DT: Multiple 1 D (2)"), a shortcut into that instance's settings.

See Trading from the Chart and Trading Panel Reference: Every Button and Field for the full trading workflow — everything there applies here.

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER] Profile Chart with the trading panel docked on the right showing the Qty field, MKT/BID-ASK/LMT/STP/STP LMT grid, Breakeven and Cancel and Flat buttons and the OCO block, with the \$ toolbar icon green `profile-chart-trading-panel.png`

Settings reference

Control	Where	What it does
Symbol dropdown	Header	Switches instrument or contract month; the chart re-downloads data (DWT: badge).

Control	Where	What it does
History dropdown (e.g. 30D - BT)	Header	How much history is loaded (30D = 30 days) and its base (BT = Based on Tick). Full option list unconfirmed.
N T dropdown	Header	Ticks grouping presets plus Set Ticks Grouping for custom values; rebuilds the chart.
Profile-type toggles	Bottom row	Multi-select; each adds/removes one profile overlay.
Trading panel toggle	Bottom row, right end	Shows/hides the docked trading panel.
Indicators (Ctrl I)	Toolbar icon / right-click	The panel managing every profile instance (trash/eye/gear per row).
Properties (Ctrl P)	Right-click	Window properties dialog, as on the price chart.
Rebuild Chart	Right-click	Clears and redraws the chart — light first fix for rendering glitches.
Template	Right-click	Save or load the window configuration (Templates and Workspaces).
Per-indicator gear	Indicators panel	Opens that profile instance's own settings dialog.

Troubleshooting

- **The chart is blank (only a dashed price line).** Every profile type is switched off. Enable one in the bottom row (start with **TPO**), or open the Indicators panel and check whether the DT/DP instances were hidden (eye) or deleted (trash). If it still will not draw, right-click → **Rebuild Chart**.
- **Stuck on Building chart / Downloading data.** The window downloads history before rendering. **LDT:** in the main bar means it is loading data from disk; **DWT:** means it is downloading from the feed server. Large history windows and tick data take time. If it never finishes while other charts load fine, see Fix: Charts Lagging or Data Delayed (Checklist) and consider re-downloading the data (Re-download Historical Data (Download Data Tool)).
- **Rows are too thin, letters unreadable.** Increase the ticks grouping (**N T** dropdown — try 20 T or 100 T, or a custom value via **Set Ticks Grouping**). The chart rebuilds with taller rows.
- **Toggles look off but overlays still draw.** A brief desync between the toggle row and the Indicators panel — open the Indicators panel and manage the instances there directly.
- **Empty instrument picker.** Nothing subscribed in Symbol Manage: Subscribe Exchanges and Map Your Feed.

Tips and common mistakes

- Do not treat the toggle row as either/or — layering TPO with a daily volume profile per session is one of the window's main strengths.
- Keep the number of enabled overlays reasonable; five or more per session gets visually dense fast. Use the Indicators panel's eye icons to park overlays instead of deleting them.
- The RTH/ETH variants are separate overlays, not filters on the main TPO — enabling **TPO (RTH)** adds an RTH-only profile next to the full-session one.
- Contract months matter: the symbol dropdown loads older contracts too, and each switch re-downloads data. See Symbol Rollover (Change Contract Month) if your symbol seems stuck on an old contract.
- The window supports the full drawing rail — profile levels you mark with horizontal lines can be managed like any chart drawing (Drawing Tools and Annotations).

Related articles

- [Market Profile \(TPO\)](#)
- [Understanding Volume Profile: POC, Value Area, HVN/LVN](#)
- [Understanding Auction Theory: Imbalance, Unfinished Auctions, Absorption](#)
- [Deep Profile \(Volume / Delta Profile\)](#)
- [Quick Chart Templates \(OF-VP, D-VP, W-VP...\)](#)
- [Trading Panel Reference: Every Button and Field](#)